StampPhoto

stampOffice suite · User manual · Boris du Reau · October 2026

1. Overview

StampPhoto shows the stamp photos and scans of a folder and converts them to **JPG** in three sizes: low, medium and high resolution. The smaller files are suited to an album, a web site, an e-mail or a wants list. The original photos are never modified.

- List of the pictures in alphabetical order, with the name of the picture shown.
- Search by beginning of name, which selects all the matching pictures at once.
- Conversion of the picture shown, of the selection or of the whole folder, which can be stopped.
- French or English interface, which can be changed without restarting.

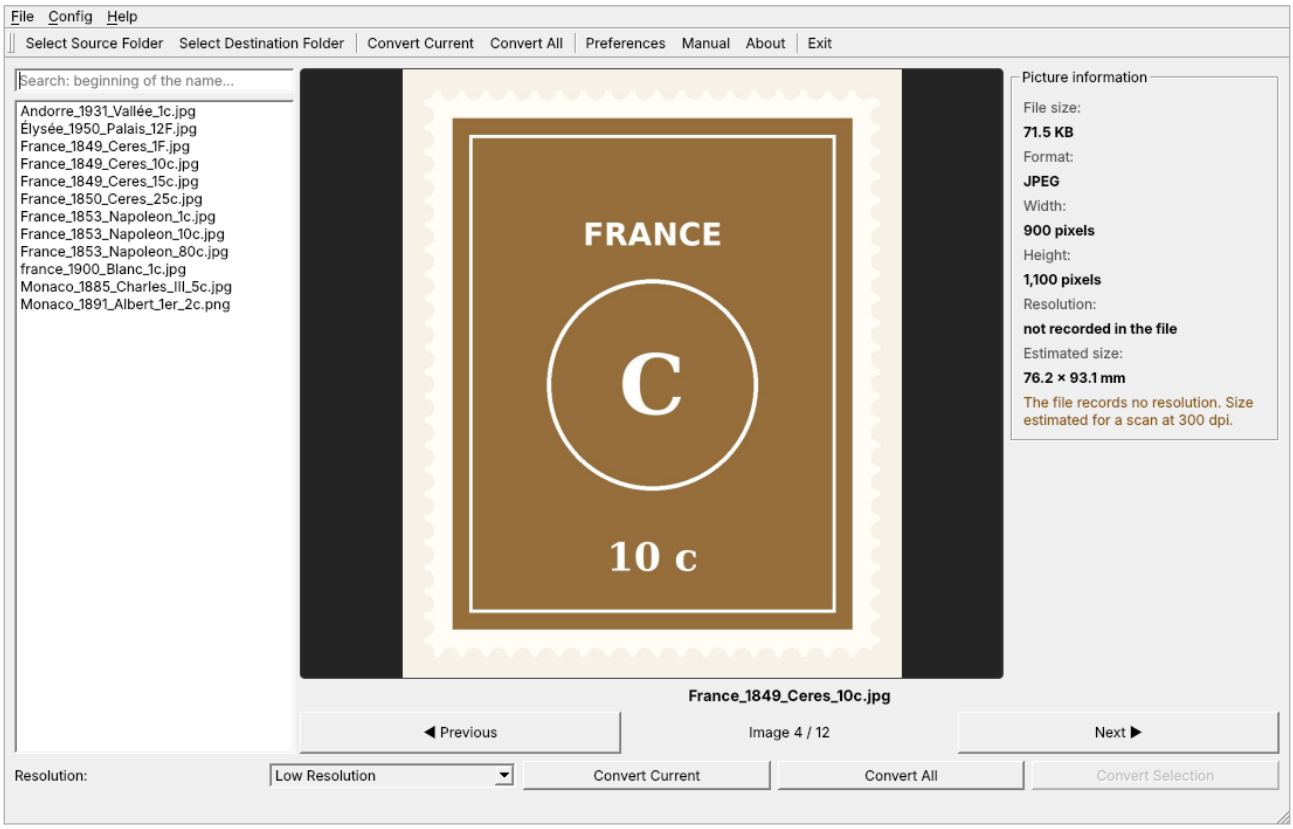
2. Installation and start-up

Item	Location
StampPhoto.py, SPAbout.py, SPConfig.py, StampPhoto.ico	Program folder
Icons and StampPhoto.png	**Images** folder, at the same level as the program folder (../Images)
PDF manuals	**Help** folder (../Help)
Translations	locale/fr/LC_MESSAGES/stampphoto.mo

StampPhoto needs Python 3, PyQt6 and Pillow:

```
pip install PyQt6 Pillow
python StampPhoto.py
```

3. The main window



The main window

Area	Purpose
Toolbar	Select the source folder, select the destination folder, convert the current picture, convert all, preferences, manual, about, exit. The name of each button appears when the mouse rests on it.
Search (top left)	Selects the pictures whose name starts with the text typed (see chapter 6).
Picture list (left)	All the pictures of the source folder, in alphabetical order.
Preview (right)	The current picture, with its name below it and its position (Image 4 / 12).
Information (right)	File size, format, pixels, resolution and estimated size of the picture shown (see chapter 5).
Previous / Next	Previous or next picture in the order of the list.
Conversion bar	Choice of the resolution and the Convert Current, Convert All and Convert Selection buttons.

4. Browsing the pictures

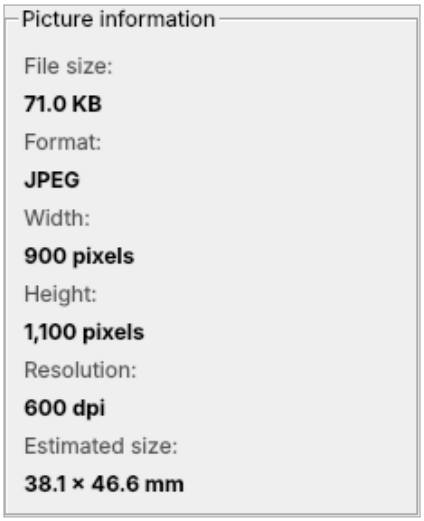
1. Click **Select Source Folder** and choose the folder of your photos. JPG, PNG, BMP, TIFF (.tif, .tiff) and WEBP files are read. At the next start, StampPhoto opens this folder again.
2. Scroll the list or use **Previous** and **Next**. A click in the list shows the picture; the arrow keys move from one picture to the next when the list has the focus.
3. The name of the picture shown appears in bold below the preview; it can be selected and copied.

The list follows the **natural alphabetical order**: numbers are compared as numbers (*Ceres_1F*, then *Ceres_10c*, then *Ceres_15c*), and upper/lower case and accents are ignored (*Élysée* is sorted with the "e"). Pictures rotated by a camera or a phone are shown the right way up.

5. Picture information

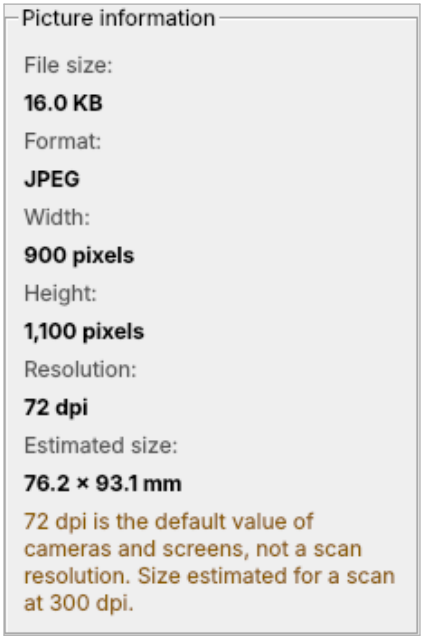
The panel on the right of the picture gives the characteristics of the picture shown:

Information	Meaning
File size	Space used on the disk, in kilobytes (KB).
Format	JPEG, PNG, TIFF, BMP or WEBP.
Width, Height	Number of pixels of the picture, the way it is displayed.
Resolution	Resolution in dots per inch (dpi) recorded in the file by the scanner or the camera.
Estimated size	Real size of the stamp in millimetres: number of pixels ÷ resolution × 25.4.



Scan at 600 dpi: 900 × 1,100 pixels, i.e. 38.1 × 46.6 mm

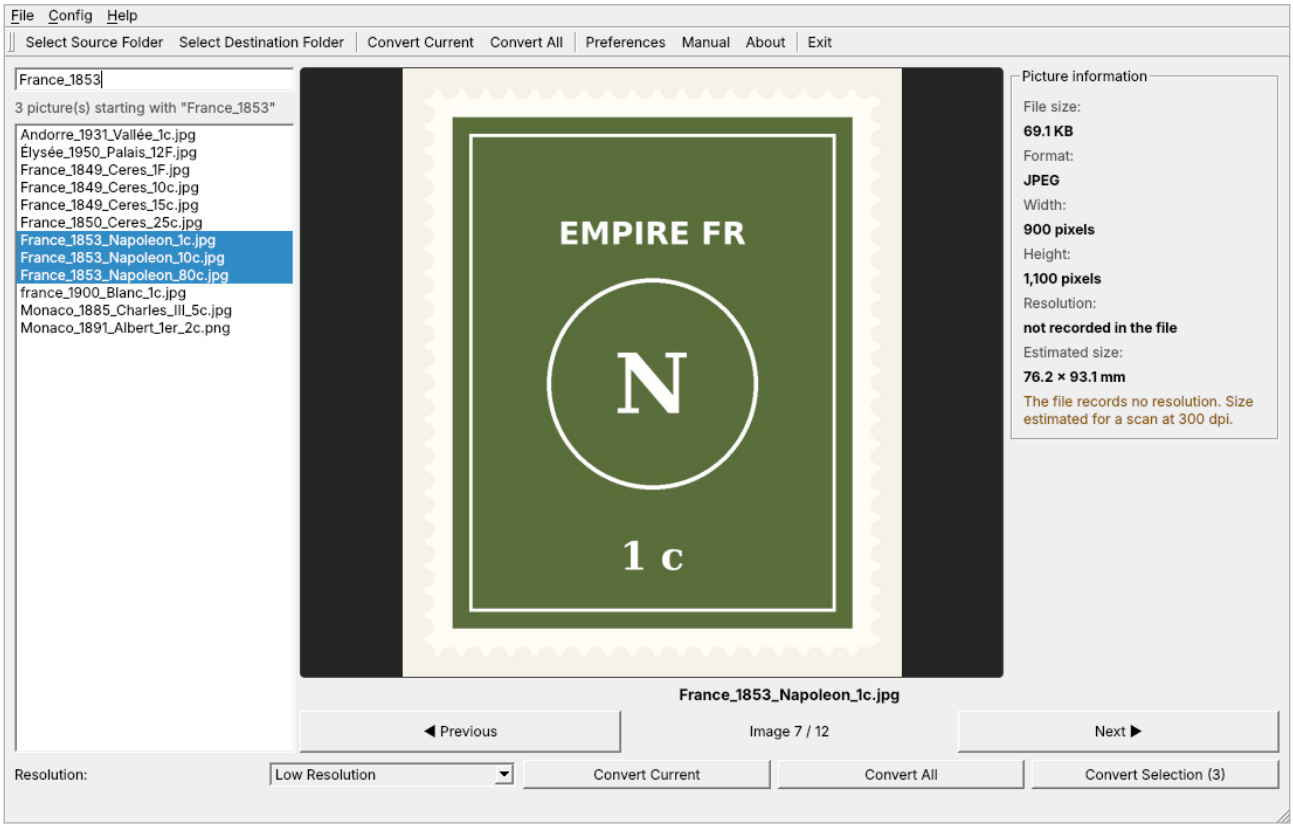
The size in mm is only right when the file contains the real scan resolution. Cameras and phones almost always record 72 dpi, whatever the size of the stamp photographed: in that case, or when the file records no resolution, StampPhoto computes the size for a scan at **300 dpi** and says so below the size.



Phone photo at 72 dpi: size estimated for a scan at 300 dpi

6. Searching and selecting pictures

Type the **beginning of a name** in the search box: all the pictures whose name starts with this text are selected in the list, the first one is shown and their number appears below the search box. Upper/lower case and accents are ignored.



Search "France_1853": the three matching pictures are selected

Search	Pictures selected
France_1849	All those whose name starts with France_1849

Search	Pictures selected
france_1853	The same as France_1853 (case ignored)
ely	Élysée_1950_Palais_12F.jpg (accents ignored)
France_18*_10c	The * wildcard stands for any text: France_1849_Ceres_10c, France_1853_Napoleon_10c...
Monaco_189?	The **?** wildcard stands for one character: Monaco_1890 to Monaco_1899

The selection can also be made or completed by hand: **Ctrl+click** adds or removes a picture, **Shift+click** selects a range of pictures. The **Convert Selection** button shows the number of selected pictures. Clearing the search (cross on the right of the box) keeps the selection.

7. Converting

1. Click **Select Destination Folder**. It is remembered for the next times.
2. Choose the **resolution**: low, medium, high, or all resolutions (three files per picture).
3. Click **Convert Current** (picture shown), **Convert Selection** or **Convert All** (whole folder).

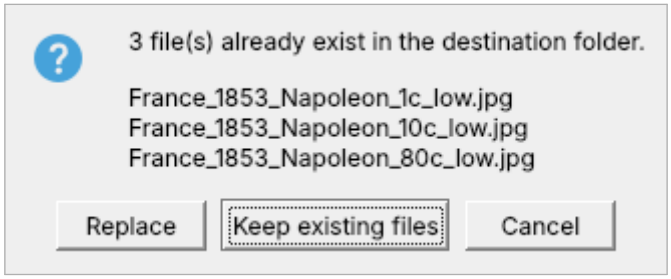
Resolution	Size of the longest side	Name of the file created
Low	800 pixels	*name*_low.jpg
Medium	1,600 pixels	*name*_med.jpg
High	2,400 pixels	*name*_high.jpg

These sizes are the default values; they can be changed in the preferences. The size limits the **longest side** of the picture, so portrait and landscape stamps are reduced alike. A picture smaller than the chosen size is not enlarged.

- The orientation recorded by the camera is applied: the converted picture is the right way up.
- Transparent areas (PNG) become white, as JPG has no transparency.
- Two pictures with the same name (*timbre.png* and *timbre.jpg*) give two different files: *timbre_png_low.jpg* and *timbre_jpg_low.jpg*.

Files already in the destination

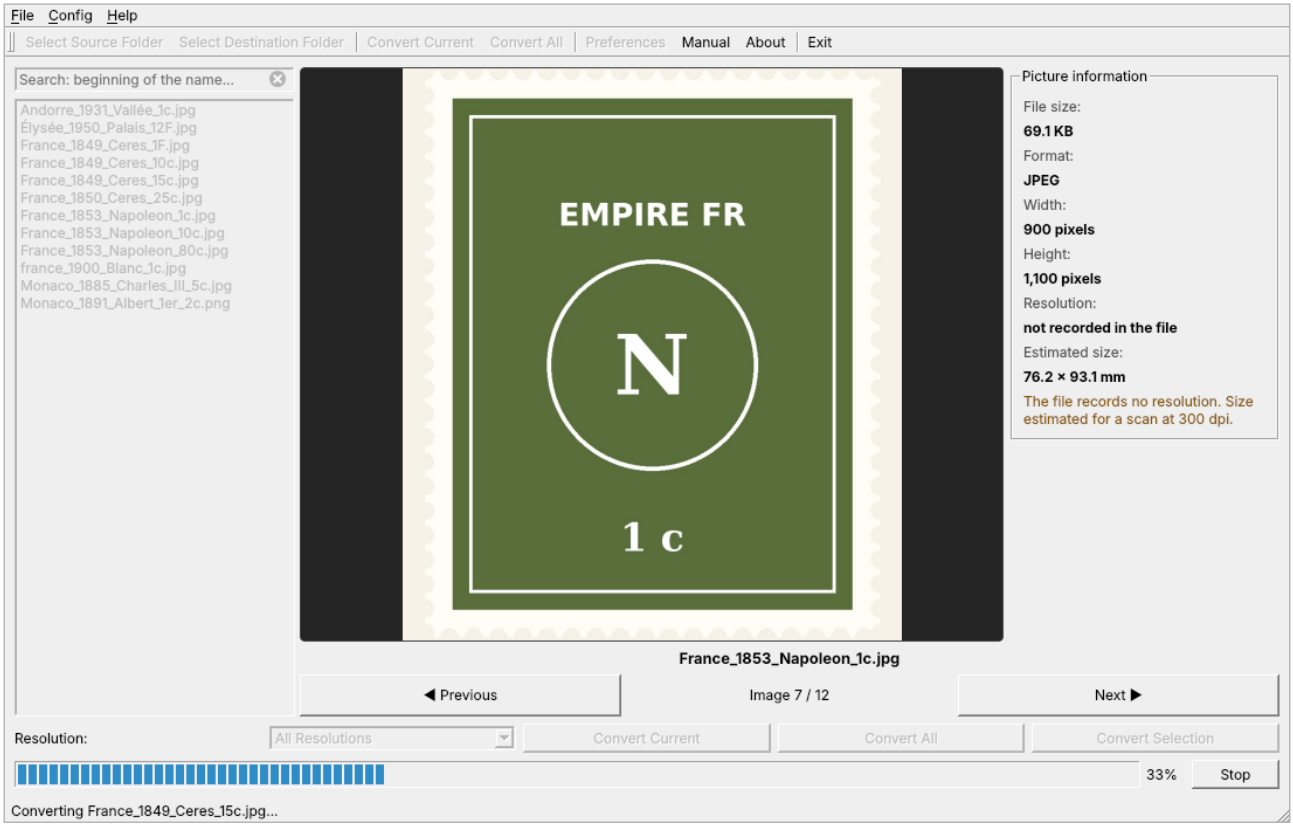
If converted files already exist, StampPhoto says so before starting: **Replace** rewrites them, **Keep existing files** only converts the missing pictures, **Cancel** does nothing.



Files already exist in the destination

8. Following and stopping a conversion

While a selection or the folder is converted, a progress bar and the **Stop** button appear; the status bar shows the picture being converted. The commands are greyed out so that a second conversion cannot be started on top of the first one.

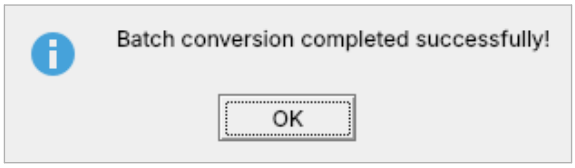


Conversion in progress

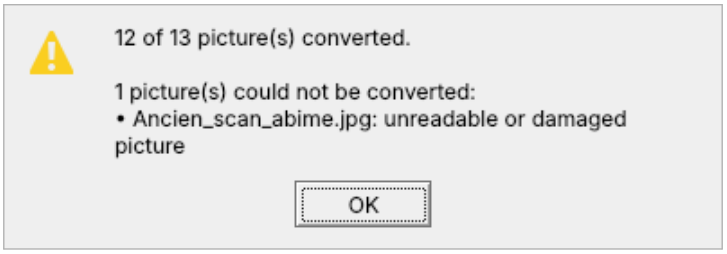
Stop finishes the current picture, then stops: the pictures already converted stay in the destination. Closing the window during a conversion offers to stop it and then exit.

9. Result

At the end, a message gives the result. An unreadable picture (damaged file, unknown format) or a write-protected destination folder does not interrupt the conversion: the other pictures are converted, and the message lists the pictures that failed with the reason.



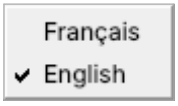
Successful conversion



One picture could not be converted

10. Language and preferences

The language is chosen in **Config › Language**; the active language is checked and the interface changes immediately. **Config › Preferences...** opens the window of the conversion settings.



Config › Language

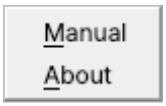
The settings are saved in the text file **StampPhoto.cfg**, in the application folder (the one that contains Images and Help), or in the user's settings folder if that folder is write-protected:

Setting	Purpose	Default
[General] language	Interface language (fr, en)	fr
[General] last_source_dir / last_dest_dir	Last source and destination folders	
[General] jpeg_quality	JPG quality, from 1 to 95	85
[Resolutions] low_width	Longest side in low resolution (pixels)	800
[Resolutions] medium_width	Longest side in medium resolution	1600
[Resolutions] high_width	Longest side in high resolution	2400

11. Troubleshooting

Situation	Solution
"No images found in the selected folder."	The folder contains no JPG, PNG, BMP, TIFF or WEBP file, or the photos are in sub-folders: choose the sub-folder.
"unreadable or damaged picture"	The file is damaged or is not a picture: open it in another program to check it.
"permission denied in the destination folder"	Choose a folder where you are allowed to write.
The search finds nothing	It looks at the **beginning** of the name; to search inside the name, start with * (for example *Napoleon).
The manual does not open	Put the PDF in the Help folder, next to the Images folder. Without the PDF, Help › Manual shows a short summary of the use.

12. Help



Help menu

Help › Manual opens this manual in the language of the interface; **Help › About** presents the application. StampPhoto is part of the stampOffice suite, written by **Boris du Reau**.